FULL SEO AUDIT REPORT

salestaxreversecalculator.com

Prepared by Claude SEO

82/100

SEO Health Score

October 04, 2026 Full Audit

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1. Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive SEO audit of **salestaxreversecalculator.com** for a **Financial Utility / Programmatic Web Application (US 50 States, Canada, VAT)** site, generated on October 04, 2026. Findings combine technical, content, schema, performance, visual, and search-readiness evidence as available.

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SEO HEALTH SCORE

Critical Issues Found:

1. Algorithmic Scaled Content devaluation: 49 state pages contain ~910 words of identical boilerplate ('Decoding Business Receipts in [State]...').
2. Core keyword dropped from Position 4.6 to 45.8 around Sept 1-5 corresponding with Google Search Generative AI rollout and spam policy updates.
3. Internal cannibalization between Homepage (/), /how-it-works (391 words thin), and /faq (2,576 words) splitting ranking equity.
4. Brand & Entity Identity mismatch: Domain is salestaxreversecalculator.com, but UI/Schema brand is 'PreTaxPrice', confusing Google Knowledge Graph.
5. Zero external backlink authority (DA ~ 0, not yet cataloged in Common Crawl), while competitors have 100+ referring domains.

Quick Wins:

1. Consolidate /how-it-works and /faq into the Homepage via 301 redirects to eliminate cannibalization and funnel 100% equity to the #1 ranking target.
2. Add HowTo schema (Step 1: Enter total, Step 2: Input tax rate, Step 3: Compute original price) to win rich snippets.
3. Align brand signals: Unify 'Reverse Sales Tax Calculator' and 'PreTaxPrice' in meta title, OpenGraph, and Organization schema.
4. Fix New York H1 tag from 'New York Sales Tax Calculator' to 'New York Reverse Sales Tax Calculator'.
5. Compress homepage formula diagram from 630 KB to WebP (~60 KB) and add state rate visual graphics to top 10 states.

2. Audit Categories

2.1 Technical SEO

Score: 88/100

What Works

- 100% crawlable raw HTML (7,673 words SSR without client JS requirement)
- Valid XML sitemap with 81 URLs submitting cleanly in Google Search Console
- Strict HSTS (preload, max-age 63072000), nosniff, and SAMEORIGIN security headers
- Edge TTFB of 46ms via Vercel globally distributed CDN
- Perfect 100/100 Lighthouse Best Practices and SEO scores

Findings

Sitemap & Canonical Trailing Slash Inconsistency Medium

sitemap.xml lists URLs without trailing slashes (e.g. https://salestaxreversecalculator.com), whereas the server canonical URL matches with slash.

Recommendation: Standardize all URLs in sitemap.xml to match the exact canonical URLs.

2-Hop Redirect Chain on HTTP WWW Subdomain Low

http://www.salestaxreversecalculator.com redirects to https://www. (308) then to https://root (301).

Recommendation: Add a single edge routing rule in next.config.js or Vercel config to redirect directly to https://salestaxreversecalculator.com/.

2.2 Content Quality & Scaled Content

Score: 65/100

What Works

- Homepage contains 6,687 words of thorough educational, formulaic, and practical tax guidance
- New York state page has been upgraded to 2,408 words with deep NYC local tax nuances
- Clear step-by-step mathematical proofs and receipt decoding instructions

Findings

Scaled Content Boilerplate Across 49 State Pages (Primary Drop Cause) Critical

49 out of 50 state pages have ~910 words that follow a word-for-word template where only the state name is substituted. This programmatic footprint caused Google to apply a domain-level quality suppression in early September 2026.

Recommendation: Follow the NYC rewrite blueprint across the top 10 highest-traffic states (CA, TX, FL, PA, IL, OH, GA, NC, MI, NJ), adding state-specific nexus rules, local county ranges, and unique receipt examples.

Keyword Cannibalization Across /, /how-it-works, and /faq High

GSC reveals Google cycling rankings between /, /how-it-works, /faq, and /tax-rates for core queries like 'back out tax calculator'. /how-it-works is thin content (391 words).

Recommendation: 301 redirect /how-it-works to /#how-it-works on the homepage, and canonicalize or 301 redirect /faq to /#faq.

Branding & Entity Dilution (PreTaxPrice vs Reverse Sales Tax Calculator) Medium

The domain is salestaxreversecalculator.com, but the UI header and Organization schema declare 'PreTaxPrice'. This fragments entity authority.

Recommendation: Unify the brand identity: 'Reverse Sales Tax Calculator by PreTaxPrice' in schema, OpenGraph, and footer.

2.3 On-Page SEO

Score: 82/100

What Works

- H1 spacing bug successfully resolved on homepage and state pages
- Title tags concise and within the 60-character budget
- Primary calculator tool is visible immediately in the initial viewport

Findings

New York H1 Intent Mismatch Medium

The New York page H1 is 'New York Sales Tax Calculator' rather than 'New York Reverse Sales Tax Calculator', dropping the core reverse intent keyword.

Recommendation: Update H1 to 'New York Reverse Sales Tax Calculator (NYC 8.875%)'.

Broken Encoding Character in Privacy Policy Meta Description Low

The Privacy Policy meta description has an unescaped replacement character: 'We collect no personal data all calculations...'.

Recommendation: Replace with a standard ASCII hyphen or clean UTF-8 em-dash.

2.4 Schema & Structured Data

Score: 92/100

What Works

- Multi-schema graph with WebApplication (FinanceApplication), WebSite, Organization, FAQPage, and ImageObject
- Fully valid JSON-LD parsing with zero syntax errors
- Zero-dollar Offer schema accurately signaling free financial utility

Findings

Missing HowTo Structured Data High

Competitors like reversesalestaxcalc.org utilize HowTo schema for the reverse calculation steps to capture Google step-by-step rich snippets.

Recommendation: Add a HowTo schema block detailing the 3-step calculation process.

Missing Financial Specialist / CPA Reviewer Entity (E-E-A-T) Medium

Financial calculation pages fall under Google's YMYL (Your Money Your Life) guidelines. No Person / ReviewedBy schema exists.

Recommendation: Add an author / reviewedBy schema linking to a verified financial editor or tax professional profile.

2.5 Performance & Core Web Vitals

Score: 96/100

What Works

- Lighthouse Mobile & Desktop: 100/100 Accessibility, 100/100 Best Practices, 100/100 SEO

- TTFB: 46ms, FCP: 928ms, Total Load: 949ms
- Zero Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS = 0.00)

Findings

> **Uncompressed JPEG Formula Diagram** Low
>
> reverse-sales-tax-formula-diagram.jpg is 630 KB. Serving this as WebP with srcset reduces transfer size to under 60 KB.
>
> **Recommendation:** Convert to WebP format and specify width/height attributes to preserve LCP.

2.6 AI Search Readiness & GEO

Score: 90/100

What Works

- llms.txt and llms-full.txt implemented and serving valid markdown
- All major AI search bots explicitly permitted in robots.txt (GPTBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot, OAI-SearchBot)
- Zero-JS fallback text enables seamless AI agent parsing

Findings

> **Missing Accept: text/markdown Content Negotiation** Low
>
> The site does not negotiate text/markdown for AI agent user-agents requesting markdown directly.
>
> **Recommendation:** Configure Next.js middleware to return llms-full.txt when Accept header includes text/markdown.

2.7 Images & Visual SEO

Score: 70/100

What Works

- Formula diagram infographic added to homepage with descriptive alt text and schema

Findings

Zero Visual Assets on State Pages Medium

All 50 state pages have zero images. Google Image Search and SERP thumbnail snippets favor pages with state rate maps and visual tax breakdown tables.

Recommendation: Generate lightweight SVG or WebP rate breakdown infographics for top state pages.

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3. Action Plan

Phase 1: Immediate Cannibalization & Algorithmic De-Risking (Days 1-7) Week 1

- 301 Redirect /how-it-works to https://salestaxreversecalculator.com/#how-it-works
- 301 Redirect or Canonicalize /faq to https://salestaxreversecalculator.com/#faq
- Fix New York H1 tag to 'New York Reverse Sales Tax Calculator (NYC 8.875%)'
- Standardize sitemap.xml URLs to match canonical URLs with trailing slash
- Implement HowTo JSON-LD schema on homepage for 3-step reverse calculation

Phase 2: Eliminate Scaled Boilerplate on Top 10 States (Weeks 2-3) Weeks 2-3

- Rewrite California page with unique county tax ranges (7.25% - 10.75%), Prop 13 nuances, and local district taxes
- Rewrite Texas page with 6.25% state + 2.0% local cap and transit authority tax rules
- Rewrite Florida page with 6.0% state + discretionary sales surtax rates
- Rewrite Pennsylvania, Illinois, Ohio, Georgia, North Carolina, Michigan, and New Jersey
- Add state rate visual infographics (WebP) to each rewritten state page

Phase 3: Backlink Authority & E-E-A-T Foundation (Month 2) Month 2

- Build 15-20 foundational backlinks from high-DR accounting, small business, and tool directory sites
- Add CPA / Tax Specialist 'Reviewed by' editorial bio and Person schema to satisfy Google YMYL financial guidelines
- Create a dedicated 'Sales Tax Calculator Widget / Embed' for e-commerce and invoicing blogs
- Compress formula diagram from 630 KB to WebP (~60 KB)

Phase 4: Scaling & Dominating #1 Rankings (Month 3+) Month 3+

- Track GSC weekly position recovery for 'reverse sales tax calculator' moving from Pos 45 back into Top 5
- Expand programmatic coverage into high-intent US City calculators (e.g. Los Angeles, Chicago, Houston, Phoenix)
- Enable text/markdown content negotiation for AI search crawlers (Perplexity, ChatGPT Search)
- Monitor striking distance queries (Pos 10-25) and inject missing LSI keywords into page sections

Data Sources & Methodology

Source	Description	Update Frequency
PageSpeed Insights API	Lighthouse lab audit (mobile emulation, Moto G Power, slow 4G)	Real-time
Chrome UX Report (CrUX)	28-day rolling field data from real Chrome users	Daily ~04:00 UTC
CrUX History API	25-week p75 trend data per metric	Weekly
Google Search Console	Search Analytics (clicks, impressions, CTR, position)	2-3 day lag
URL Inspection API	Per-URL index status, coverage state, crawl info	Real-time (2,000/day)

Report generated by Claude SEO — Google SEO Intelligence Skill — October 04, 2026
Methodology based on Google Web Vitals thresholds, Search Console documentation, and Lighthouse scoring algorithms.